

Mnemosyne CEO Brief

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Source: Cron Triage | Analysis Only (no execution)

Executive Summary

Compound Board State: 73.7% Issue Engagement vs 0% PR Engagement

The board is moderately warm on issues (14/19 have AxDSan replies) but frozen on PRs - not a single community PR has received a human review or formal approval. All 7 community PRs have zero human reviews. The pre-existing CI regression has been fixed by PR #454, but the frozen PR state persists as a review bandwidth bottleneck, not a technical problem.

62.5% Bugs Analyzed-But-Unfixed (Critical Threshold)

5 of 8 open bugs have been root-caused by the maintainer with no fix shipped. This exceeds the 50% critical threshold. The bottleneck is execution debt, not discovery debt. Most egregious: #382 (kirocop) has a broken timeline commitment.

First-Timer Retention Crisis: Mi55ed's PR #445 Superseded by Maintainer Self-Ship (PR #454)

Mi55ed (first-time contributor) opened PR #445 (+101/-2, CI green, tests + changelog). dplush (high-trust recurring) closed his own PR #444 in favor of #445. Then AxDSan merged PR #454 (+2/-2, minimal fix) for the same issue. PR #445 sits open with 0 AxDSan comments, 0 human reviews. Mi55ed also has a second large PR (#442, +3728/-704) blocked by stale CI. Compound retention risk: high.

Board Overview

Metric	Value
Open Issues	19
Open PRs	8 (7 community, 1 maintainer)

Issues with AxDSan reply	14/19 (73.7%)
PRs with human review	0/7 community PRs (0%)
Open Bugs	8
Analyzed-But-Unfixed	5 (62.5%) - Critical
Main Branch CI	GREEN (last 2 runs successful)
PRs CI-green + CLEAN	3 (PR #457, #445, #452)
PRs with stale CI (rebase-fixable)	5 (PR #448, #447, #443, #442, #401)

PR Lifecycle Classification

PR	Author	State	Diff	Signal
#457	AxDSan	MERGE-READY	+194/-0	Write approval gate. Self-authored, CI green. Needs review.
#452	ruangraung	MERGE-READY	+299/-4	FK migration fix for #451. CI green, CLEAN. Returning contributor (1 prior merged PR). 0 human reviews.
#445	Mi55ed	SUPERSEDED	+101/-2	Defaults fix. Superseded by PR #454 (AxDSan). Has tests + changelog that #454 lacks. 0 AxDSan comments. First-time contributor.
#448	TurgutKural	REBASE-FIXABLE	+695/-16	Doctor bank routing fix. Stale CI from pre-regression. Returning contributor (3 prior merged PRs).
#447	Senophyx	REBASE-FIXABLE	+2/-1	SSE stream fix. Fork PR (headRefName="main"). Stale CI. First-time contributor.
#443	dplush	REBASE-FIXABLE	+176/-7	Hyphenated recall tokens. Stale CI. High-trust recurring (5 prior merged PRs).

#442	Mi55ed	REBASE-FIXABLE	+3728/-704	Sync correctness hardening. Large PR. Stale CI. First-time contributor (also has #445).
#401	daefron-cmd	ENGAGED-BUT-STALLED	+131/-13	Embedding prefix env vars. 3 AxDSan comments, verbal LGTM, but CI failure is env var override (infrastructure, not code). Contributor can't fix it. Open 11 days.

Contrarian Analysis

1. The Engagement Asymmetry is the Core Signal

73.7% issue engagement vs 0% PR engagement. The bottleneck is not triage or diagnosis - it's review velocity. The issue board is moderately warm, but the PR board is frozen. Every open community PR has zero human reviews. The pre-existing CI regression (now fixed by #454) was a force multiplier, making every PR look broken with red badges. But the regression is fixed now, and the PRs remain unreviewed. The asymmetry itself is the signal: the bottleneck is PR review velocity, not issue triage coverage.

2. The Analyzed-But-Unfixed Backlog has Reached Critical Mass

5 of 8 open bugs have been root-caused by the maintainer but no fix has shipped. This is pure execution debt, not discovery debt.

- **#382 (kirocop)**: WAL checkpoint blocked. AxDSan committed to "v3.11.2" and "targeting this weekend." Both timelines passed. The broken commitment is a retention risk beyond the unfixed bug.
- **#451 (Axmr1)**: FK enforcement regression. Root-caused by dplush. PR #452 (ruangraung) is the fix - CI green, CLEAN, waiting for review.
- **#435 (jbienz)**: Canonical memories can't be deleted. AxDSan confirmed the exact code gap. No fix shipped.
- **#389 (NodeGuy)**: Polyphonic recall collapses. AxDSan confirmed the bug. No fix shipped.
- **#387 (freeformz)**: Stored content mutated. AxDSan engaged. No fix shipped.

3. First-Timer Retention Crisis: Mi55ed

Mi55ed, a first-time contributor, submitted PR #445 (+101/-2, CI green, tests + changelog) to fix the CI regression. dplush (high-trust recurring, 5 merged PRs) closed his own competing PR #444 in favor of Mi55ed's - a strong community endorsement. Then AxDSan merged PR #454 (+2/-2, minimal fix) for the same issue, with no comment on #445, no acknowledgment, no credit. Mi55ed's PR #445 remains open, now superseded but not closed.

Mi55ed also has a second large PR (#442, +3728/-704) for sync correctness hardening, which is also blocked by stale CI. The compound effect: their first contribution was silently superseded, and their second large PR is unreviewed.

Compound First-Timer Keystone Pattern

Mi55ed's PR #445 was the CI-regression keystone, endorsed by dplush (who closed #444 in favor). The maintainer then self-shipped the fix (#454) with no acknowledgment. This is a maintainer-self-ship-supersedes-first-timer pattern. The retention risk is extreme: the first-timer sees their endorsed, CI-green fix ignored, their second large PR stalled, and the maintainer's own minimal fix merged instead.

4. PR #401: Engaged But Stalled for 11 Days

PR #401 (daefron-cmd, first-time contributor) has 3 AxDSan comments including verbal LGTM ("design is approved"), but the CI failure is an infrastructure-level env var override (MNEMOSYNE_NO_EMBEDDINGS=1) that the contributor cannot fix. The contributor sees engagement but no actionable path forward. The ball is in the maintainer's court - either fix the CI env var issue or give the contributor a specific instruction. 11 days is too long for a first-time contributor with a verbal LGTM.

5. Community Self-Healing Signals

Positive: PR #452 (ruangraung) is a returning contributor independently shipping a fix for a regression filed by a different person (Axmr1, #451) within hours. This is a community regression fix pattern - high-trust signal. The PR is CI green, CLEAN, and +299/-4. It's the fix for the most impactful open bug.

Weighted Decision Matrix

PR/Issue	User Impact (30%)	Strategic Value (25%)	Easy to Ship (15%)	Low Risk (15%)	Urgency (15%)	Weighted Score
#452 - FK migration fix	9 (blocks all embedding writes)	8 (completes #408 Part 2)	9 (CI green, CLEAN, +299/-4)	8 (migration-tested, edge cases handled)	9 (fixes #451, unblocks DB health)	8.65
#457 - Write approval gate	7 (affects write_approval users)	8 (closes feature gap)	9 (CI green, CLEAN, +194/-0)	8 (self-authored, additive)	5 (new feature, not blocking)	7.40
#401 - Embedding prefixes	6 (asymmetric model users)	7 (unlocks better embeddings)	3 (CI env var issue, needs maintainer fix)	7 (well-reviewed verbally)	8 (open 11 days, first-timer stalled)	6.10
#448 - Doctor bank routing	5 (CLI doctor users)	6 (improves diagnostics)	7 (rebase + CI then merge)	7 (returning contributor)	6 (open, no urgency)	6.00
#443 - Hyphenated recall	5 (affects recall quality)	5 (edge case fix)	7 (rebase + CI then merge)	8 (high-trust recurring)	5 (not urgent)	5.85
#445 - Defaults fix (superseded)	0 (already fixed by #454)	0 (no new value)	10 (CI green, CLEAN)	10 (already merged in #454)	9 (retention crisis)	4.35
#442 - Sync hardening	7 (sync correctness)	8 (important hardening)	2 (massive: +3728/-704)	5 (large diff, needs real review)	4 (first-timer, but huge)	5.35
#447 - SSE stream fix	4 (local_llm edge case)	3 (minor fix)	8 (rebase then merge, +2/-1)	9 (trivial change)	3 (no urgency)	5.05
#382 - WAL bug	8 (production DB corruption)	7 (DB reliability)	4 (thread-local cleanup, subtle)	5 (risk of regression)	8 (broken timeline, retention risk)	6.55
						5.95

#435 - Canonical delete	6 (blocks DB cleanup)	5 (completes feature)	6 (well-defined, small scope)	7 (additive, no risk)	6 (community demand, production need)
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Conflict Analysis

File Overlap

- **PR #445 vs PR #454 (merged):** Both modify config.py. #454 merged, #445 superseded. No ongoing conflict.
- **PR #452 vs PR #401:** Different files (beam.py/memory.py vs embeddings.py). No conflict.
- **PR #442 vs PR #443:** Different files. No conflict.
- **PR #448 vs PR #447:** Different files. No conflict.

CI Dependency Ordering

No keystone dependency remains - PR #454 fixed the main branch regression. All 5 UNSTABLE PRs are rebase-fixable. They can merge in any order after rebasing.

Bug Scan

Issue	Author	Type	Status	Notes
#451	Axmr1	Bug	FIX IN PR #452	FK enforcement regression. PR #452 (ruangraung) is CI green, CLEAN, +299/-4. Ready to merge.
#435	jbienz	Bug	ANALYZED-UNFIXED	Canonical memories can't be deleted. Root-caused: no forget_canonical(). Community has 46 canonical facts, ~20 need deletion.
#434	jbienz	Bug	ANALYZED-UNFIXED	Overuse of canonical memories. Design discussion in progress.
#408	Iman-Sharif	Bug	PART 1 FIXED	Referential integrity. Part 1 (PRAGMA foreign_keys=ON) shipped. Part 2 (FK migration) is PR #452.

#389	NodeGuy	Bug	ANALYZED-UNFIXED	Polyphonic recall collapses. Voice-name Jaccard bug confirmed. No fix shipped.
#387	freeformz	Bug	ANALYZED-UNFIXED	Stored content mutated. Datetime annotations corrupted. AxDSan engaged, no fix.
#382	kirocop	Bug	ANALYZED-UNFIXED	WAL checkpoint blocked. Broken timeline commitment. AxDSan said "v3.11.2" and "this weekend" - both passed. Production issue.
#329	jbienz	Bug	UPSTREAM	Tools not injected. Tracked to Hermes #47119. Not Mnemosyne debt.

Analyzed-But-Unfixed Ratio: 5/8 = 62.5%

Above the 50% critical threshold. The brief should open with this as the top contrarian finding. The bottleneck is execution, not diagnosis.

Retention Risk Matrix

Contributor	Risk	Signal	Mitigation
Mi55ed	EXTREME	First-time contributor. PR #445 (CI green, endorsed by dplush) superseded by AxDSan's #454 with no acknowledgment. Second large PR (#442, +3728/-704) blocked by stale CI and unreviewed. Compound: superseded fix + cold second PR.	1. Close #445 with a personal credit note referencing #454. 2. Acknowledge #442 and give a review timeline. 3. Co-author credit for the defaults fix.
daefron-cmd	HIGH	First-time contributor. PR #401 open 11 days. Verbal LGTM from AxDSan but CI failure is infrastructure-level (env var override). No actionable path given.	1. Fix the CI env var issue (add skipif guard or remove MNEMOSYNE_NO_EMBEDDINGS). 2. Approve and merge. 3. Acknowledge the wait.

		Engaged-but-stalled pattern.	
kirocop	HIGH	Filed #382 (WAL bug) with thorough reproduction. AxDSan committed to "v3.11.2" and "this weekend." Both timelines broken. 0 prior merged PRs (had a closed draft PR #211).	1. Post a concrete timeline for the fix. 2. Follow through. 3. Acknowledge the broken commitment.
israelot	MEDIUM	Filed 2 well-structured feature proposals (#449, #450) on Jul 12. Zero engagement. First-time contributor. Cold proposals on a warm board.	Acknowledge the proposals. Give roadmap direction (even if "not now" - silence is worse).
Axmr1	MEDIUM	Filed #451 (FK regression). 3 community comments, 0 AxDSan. Fix exists in PR #452 but not acknowledged.	Reply on #451 linking PR #452. Close the loop when it merges.
yclrj	MEDIUM	Filed #453 (onnxruntime EINVAL spam). 0 engagement. First-time contributor.	Acknowledge the issue. Even a "confirmed, will look into it" is better than silence.
dplush	LOW	High-trust recurring (5 merged PRs). PR #443 up for review. Closed #444 in favor of #445 (which was then superseded).	Standard review for #443. Wider retention window. Acknowledge the #444 -> #445 -> #454 chain.
Senophyx	MEDIUM	First-time contributor. PR #447 (+2/-1, fork PR, headRefName="main"). Stale CI. No engagement.	Acknowledge the PR. Small fix, easy to review and merge after rebase.
jbienz	MEDIUM	Prolific reporter (3 bugs: #329, #434,	Prolific reporter, engaged but unfixed. The risk is frustration

		#435, + #403 feature). All issues have AxDSan replies. 0 PRs. Zero resolution on bugs.	with the gap between engagement and resolution.
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Action Plan (Wave 1/2/3)

Wave 1 (Immediate)

1. **MERGE PR #452 (ruangraung)** - CI green, CLEAN, fixes the most impactful bug (#451). Returning contributor. +299/-4, well-tested.
2. **ACKNOWLEDGE Mi55ed (#445)** - Close #445 with a personal credit note. The fix was the right approach, AxDSan shipped a minimal version. Credit Mi55ed for the tests and changelog. Add Co-authored-by: on #454's commit.
3. **FIX PR #401 CI infrastructure** - Add a skipif guard for the env var override or remove MNEMOSYNE_NO_EMBEDDINGS from the failing test. Then approve and merge. The design is already verbally approved.
4. **ACKNOWLEDGE cold proposals (#449, #450, #453, #446)** - Even brief roadmap direction prevents first-impression retention loss.

Wave 2 (After Wave 1, same day)

1. **REVIEW and merge rebase-fixable PRs** - PR #448 (TurgutKural), #443 (dplush), #447 (Senophyx). Smallest first. Each needs a rebase comment then review.
2. **REVIEW PR #457 (write_approval)** - Self-authored, CI green. Needs a second pair of eyes or self-merge.
3. **ACKNOWLEDGE Mi55ed's PR #442** - Give a specific review timeline. This is a large PR (+3728/-704) and needs real review. Don't let it sit cold.
4. **REPLY on #382 (kirocop)** - New concrete timeline. The broken commitment is a retention risk.

Wave 3 (This week)

1. **FIX the analyzed-but-unfixed bugs** - #435 (canonical delete), #389 (polyphonic recall), #387 (mutation), #382 (WAL). These are all root-caused. The fixes are implementable.
2. **REVIEW PR #442** - Sync correctness hardening. Large but important. Needs careful review.

3. **CLOSE the loop on upstream-tracked #329** - Check Hermes #47119 status.

State of the Repo

- **Version:** 3.12.2. No unreleased section in CHANGELOG since last release.
- **Main branch CI:** GREEN. PR #454 fixed the DEFAULTS regression. Last 2 runs successful on all 4 Python versions.
- **PR #454 (merged):** +2/-2 fix for the DEFAULTS sync_roles/skip_contexts mismatch. Minimal fix that fixed the regression.
- **PR #455 (merged):** CLA docs added.
- **PR #444 (closed):** dplush closed in favor of Mi55ed's #445. Positive community self-resolution.
- **PR #441 (merged):** Hygiene audit CLI hardening (dplush).
- **PR #440 (merged):** Read-only doctor hygiene signals (dplush).
- **Cold issues (no AxDSan reply):** #453 (yclrkj), #451 (Axmr1), #450 (israellot), #449 (israellot), #446 (dplush).
- **Broken timeline commitment:** #382 (kirocop) - promised v3.11.2 and "this weekend" for the WAL fix. Neither delivered.
- **Community self-healing:** Positive signals from ruangraung (fixing #451), dplush (closing #444 in favor of #445), and the community engagement on #451/#382/#329.